

# INTERVIEW: PROTOCOL

For interviews, the protocol is called a *topic list* or *topic guide*.

## Project Information

- Describe the project title & goal
- Who are the interviewers (names, contacts & organization)?

## Research goals

- What is the general goal of these interviews?
- What is the role of the interviews in the wider project?

## Respondents

- **Rationale:** Describe the rationale of your respondent selection. Kind & why these?
- **Timeframe:** Describe from when to when the respondents are interviewed
- **Sample:** Describe your sample in a table

| pseudonym | respondent type | interview date | interview location |
|-----------|-----------------|----------------|--------------------|
| George    | Doctor          | 11-12-2022     | Resp. office       |

## Research questions

- What are the main research questions? (remember, good interview questions start with how or why).
- Research questions are often divided into main questions and sub questions, or topics/themes and questions.
- Limit the amount of research questions to allow for sufficient depth (probing).

## Overview of the topic list

- Introduction
- Framing questions
- Main questions
- Wrap-up

## Topic list

### Introduction

Thank you for your willingness to participate in this research project. My name is [*name, role*] and the research project for which I'm doing this interview is called [*title*]. It's about [*project goals*]. With this interview we want to [*goal of the interview*].

To be able to analyze this interview, I will record this conversation. Is that ok? To comply with privacy regulations I will also need you to sign an informed consent [*present and sign informed consent, then start recording*].

### Framing questions

Framing questions usually include ...

- **An introduction of the respondent**  
(who are you, what do you do, how do you relate to my topic, ...)
- **Open questions regarding the topic**  
(what do you think the main issues are in ..., how do/did you experience, ..., ...)

### Main questions

Main questions usually include ...

- 1 to 3 topics that are being discussed.
- Probing questions to stimulate in-depth answers

### Wrap-up

The wrap up usually includes ...

- An open question: Do you want to add anything else?
- A confirmatory wrap up: The main things I learned in this interview are, ... Did I interpret this correctly? Which are the highlights you think I should remember most?.
- It is a good idea to ask if you can take a picture at the end of the interview. This does not need to be a (recognizable) picture of the respondent. Make it meaningful for your research.